

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **J&J agreed to acquire** mental-illness-drug developer Intra-Cellular for about \$15 billion, evidence of pharma's renewed interest in neuroscience investments with vast but unrealized promise. **B1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** ended mixed, with the S&P 500 and Dow gaining 0.2% and 0.9%, respectively, and the Nasdaq retreating 0.4%. **B10**
- ◆ **Goldman said it would** create a Capital Solutions group, fusing three operations in the firm's global banking and markets division that work to find or facilitate financing deals. **B1**
- ◆ **Starbucks reversed** a policy of free access to its cafes and will impose a code of conduct aimed at improving staff and patron safety and its retail ambience. **B1**
- ◆ **Cleveland-Cliffs is** discussing joining Nucor for a possible bid for U.S. Steel that is likely months away from being declared, people familiar with the matter said. **B3**
- ◆ **The FTC is preparing** a lawsuit against Greystar, the country's largest apartment landlord, alleging the firm charged tenants hidden fees. **B4**
- ◆ **Prediction-market startup** Kalshi appointed Donald Trump Jr. as an adviser on forging new partnerships and reaching a broader audience. **B4**
- ◆ **Apple defended itself** in a hearing of a \$1.8 billion U.K. lawsuit accusing the company of abusing its dominance in the digital economy and overcharging App Store customers. **B4**
- ◆ **Jeff Bezos' space company**, Blue Origin, postponed the inaugural launch of its new rocket after experiencing technical problems. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **The resurgence of** powerful winds in Southern California threatened to slow the containment of historically destructive wildfires that have so far killed 24 people and destroyed thousands of homes. **A4**
- ◆ **A shrinking California** insurance market will leave Los Angeles-area residents more dependent on a patchwork of federal programs, charitable aid and their own savings to rebuild after the fires. **A4**
- ◆ **A large reservoir** that is out of commission, potentially hampering firefighting efforts, has twice required repairs in recent years. **A4**
- ◆ **Greenland's prime minister** said his island had no interest in becoming part of the U.S., but was open to building closer ties with Washington on security and resource exploitation. **A16**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** can publicly release special counsel Jack Smith's investigative report on Trump's 2020 election interference case, a federal judge said. **A2**
- ◆ **The special counsel** who prosecuted Hunter Biden issued a rebuke of President Biden's claims that his son was unfairly targeted, calling the accusations baseless. **A3**
- ◆ **Trump's choice to lead** the CIA, John Ratcliffe, is likely to push for more-aggressive spying operations targeting Beijing if confirmed to lead the agency. **A3**
- ◆ **A U.S. push** to arrange a prisoner swap with the Taliban is in danger of collapsing over Biden's insistence that it include an American missing since 2022. **A8**

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Hopes Grow for a Gaza Cease-Fire



DEMANDS FOR A DEAL: Demonstrators rallied Monday in Tel Aviv to call for the release of Israeli hostages held in Gaza. President Biden said Israel and Hamas are on the brink of an agreement that would see the return of some hostages and a pause in the fighting. **A8**

Fake-Job Postings Proliferate, Prompting Frustration

By LYNN COOK

It is a common feeling when looking at a job listing online: the title is perfect, the pay is right, and the company seems like a solid place to work.

But you also wonder if that job is real.

Lots of job seekers have a story about the postings that linger online but never seem to get filled. Those so-called ghost jobs—the roles that companies advertise but have no intention of filling—might account for as much as one in five jobs advertised online.

That is according to an analysis of internal data by Greenhouse, a hiring platform that examined its clients' job postings and hiring action during the past year. Greenhouse and LinkedIn recently have begun tagging job listings as verified to give workers better information amid the rash of ghost listings.

The listings are dispiriting for workers, leading many to distrust potential employers and make a difficult process feel rigged against them.

Using data that Greenhouse collects from its clients who hire in technology, finance and healthcare, among other sectors, Greenhouse figured out that between 18% and 22% of jobs advertised in 2024 were appeals for new workers that never actually got filled.

"It's kind of a horror show," said Jon Stross, the company's president and co-founder. "The job market has become more soul-crushing than ever."

Companies have a number of nefarious and normal rea-

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INSIDE



BUSINESS & FINANCE
America's bourbon boom is over, and distillers big and small are starting to hurt. **B1**

SPORTS
The NFL playoffs deliver a quarterback showdown for the ages. **A12**

Gym Rats Can't Wait for You To Give Up on Your Resolution

In January, gyms become battlegrounds pitting regulars against rule-breakers

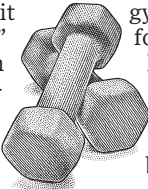
By GRETCHEN TARRANT GULLA

Heshie Brody knows what to expect at his local gym in January. Yet every year, the software engineer is surprised by the volume of new faces and level of chaos.

"It's packed. Your favorite locker is taken. The treadmills are full. You have to wait in line for the shower," Brody, 29, said of his gym in Brooklyn, N.Y. It's difficult to empathize, he said, when he knows many of the newcomers won't be back.

"Listen, I respect your New Year's resolution," Brody said. "But I'll be impressed if you're still showing up in February."

At gyms across America, regulars are holding their breath for the end of the January rush.



Not pumped

To Woo Trump, Zuckerberg Unleashes the 'Real Mark'

Mark Zuckerberg wants Donald Trump to get to know the "real Mark."

That is the latest message the shape-shifting chief executive sought to relay to the

By Meghan Bobrowsky, Rebecca Ballhaus and Annie Linskey

masses as he pushes an increasingly frenzied effort to recast himself as a friend of President-elect Trump at a moment of peril and opportunity for Meta Platforms.

On Friday, he met with the president-elect in Florida for the second time in seven

Wildfires Stir Political Storm Around Mayor

LOS ANGELES—Karen Bass beat the billionaire real-estate developer Rick Caruso in Los Angeles's 2022 mayoral race. But Caruso reappeared this past

By Erich Schwartzel, Katherine Sayre and Peter Grant

week as the mayor's top critic as Bass faces a mounting backlash over the response to the unprecedented wildfires ravaging the city.

"The basic fundamentals of leadership start with being present," Caruso, 66 years old, said in a post on X on Friday, a veiled swipe at Bass's absence from the city when the fires broke out.

Bass, 71, has said that while she was away, she was in regular contact with deputies and officials. She also said political sniping accomplished little.

"We will reject those who seek to divide us and seek to misinform," she said at a news conference Thursday.

Caruso, a centrist, former Republican, was once known to most Angelenos as a developer of high-end outdoor shopping malls. He is being urged by supporters to run for office again, possibly for gov-

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◆ **Fire crews unable to tap** reservoir under repair.... **A4**
◆ **Estimates of cost for** insurers are rising..... **B11**

Middle-Class Dream Goes Up in Flames

LOS ANGELES — Sylvia Sweeney and her husband, Bob Honeychurch, bought their three-bedroom home nestled in the foothills of the San Gabriel

By Rebecca Picciotto, Nicole Friedman and Dan Frosch

Valley for \$780,000 in 2009. At the start of this year, it was worth more than double that—\$1.6 million, by one estimate.

On Wednesday, raging wildfires swept through their Altadena neighborhood. When the couple went back later that day to see what was left of their home, all that was

standing was the mailbox.

Sweeney, a 69-year old retired clergywoman, estimates that her home made up roughly 80% of the family's overall wealth.

"It was our beautiful dream home," she said. "It was our primary wealth."

Towering flames powered by hurricane-force winds have destroyed or damaged more than 12,000 structures in Los Angeles County, razing some of the city's priciest real estate on streets thick with celebrity mansions.

The fires also wiped out the homes of Californians in the

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neutered, or like, emasculated," Zuckerberg said in an interview with the podcaster, who endorsed Trump, a Republican, just before the election.

"When you're running a company, people typically don't want to see you being like this ruthless person," he said. He said that people who have seen him competing in jujitsu have remarked, "That's the real Mark."

The day capped off the latest iteration of Zuckerberg's long-time inclination to "move fast and break things," a mantra he has used to steer himself and his company through one crisis after another for two decades.

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Agentforce What AI Was Meant to Be